Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
The Republic of El Salvador

Reference Date: 05-January-2026

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Aggregate 2025 maize output anticipated at near-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements forecast at above-average level in 2025/26**
- **Despite seasonal declines in October and November 2025, prices of white maize and red beans higher year-on-year**

Aggregate 2025 maize output anticipated at near-average level

Harvesting of the 2025 minor season *Postrera* maize crops, accounting for about 20 percent of the total annual production, is about to start in January 2026. Despite the high costs of agricultural inputs, the area planted is estimated to be slightly above the five-year average due to higher year-on-year maize prices at planting time. Above-average precipitation amounts between September and mid-October 2025 caused localized floodings and landslides, particularly in coastal areas, and saturated soils hampered planting operations. Adequate soil moisture conditions were restored from mid-October 2025 onwards and yields are estimated near the average.

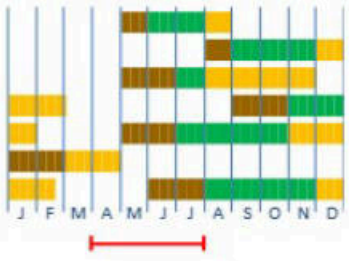
The harvest of the 2025 main season maize crops concluded in November 2025. Planting operations started in June 2025, with approximately a one-month delay due to low precipitation amounts in most of the key cropping areas. Adequate rainfall amounts in June and July 2025 restored favourable conditions for crop development. On aggregate, for the 2025 maize output is estimated at a near-average level of 805 000 tonnes, rebounding from the low outturn of production in 2024, when above-average rainfall amounts during the minor season caused crop losses.

Cereal import requirements forecast at above-average level in 2025/26

Cereal imports account for about 50 percent of the total consumption needs. Cereal import requirements in the 2025/26 marketing year (September/August) are forecast at 1.27 million tonnes, about 10 percent above the average. Since the removal of the import tariffs on basic food items and main agricultural inputs in March 2022, cereal imports have been on the rise. The high level reflects the strong demand of wheat and white maize for domestic consumption as well as of yellow maize by the feeding industry.

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



El Salvador

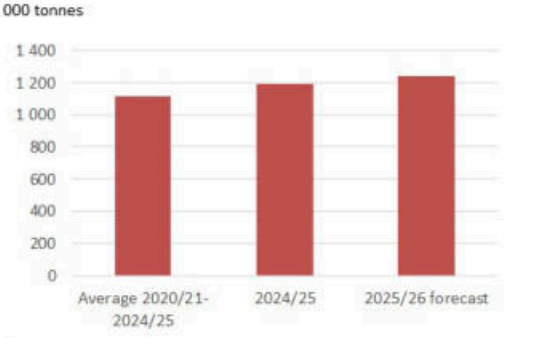
Cereal Production

	2020-2024 average	2024	2025 estimate	change 2025/2024
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	793	785	805	2.5
Sorghum	102	99	99	0.0
Rice (paddy)	16	11	12	5.0
Total	911	895	916	2.3

Note: Percentage change calculated from unrounded data.

El Salvador

Cereals Imports



Notes: Includes rice in milled terms. Split years refer to individual crop marketing years (for rice, calendar year of second year shown).

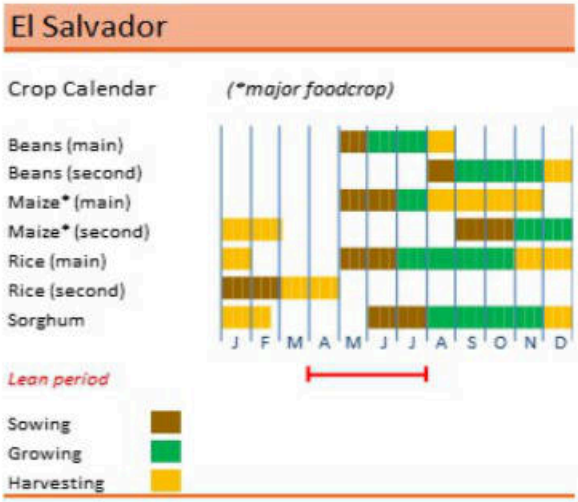
Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
The Republic of El Salvador

Reference Date: 25-November-2024

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

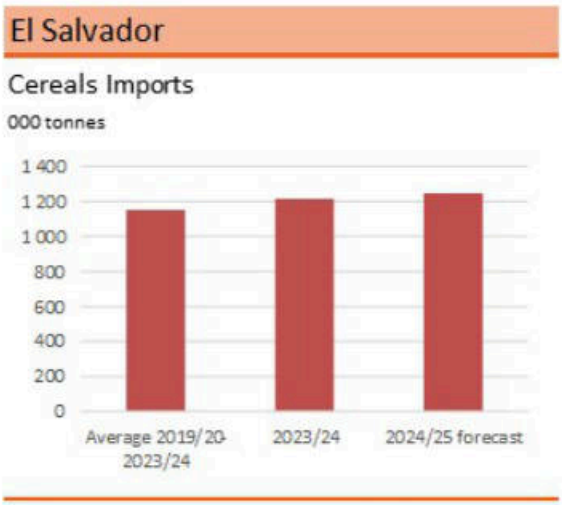
- **Production of 2024 main season maize crops estimated below average due to unfavourable weather conditions**
- **Lower year-on-year maize prices discouraged plantings of 2025 minor season maize crops**
- **Cereal import requirements, mostly yellow maize and wheat, anticipated slightly above average in 2024/25**
- **Prices of white maize and red beans seasonally decreased in September 2024**



Production of 2024 main season maize crops estimated below average due to unfavourable weather conditions

Harvesting of the 2024 main *primera* season maize crops is nearing completion, later than usual, after severe dry weather conditions at the beginning of the season in May 2024 delayed plantings by one month. The rainy season started late in June, with above-average precipitation amounts causing floods and landslides, and leading to the state of emergency. In July and August 2024, erratic rains further increased cumulative rainfall amounts, providing conducive conditions for crop development. The government inaugurated, in April 2024, the *Siembra de Maíz de Alto Rendimiento (SMAR)* programme, providing smallholder farmers mechanization services, machinery and trainings to improve yields for maize crops. However, according to FAO's preliminary estimates, the output is foreseen to be slightly below the average, as the positive effect of the SMAR programme on productivity was more than offset by dry weather conditions at the planting stage, that deterred farmers' sowing intentions, resulting in a below-average planted area.

Additionally, in May 2024, the government approved the *Bono Agrícola*, a measure that modified the existing programme for smallholder farmers (*Programa Paquetes Agrícolas*) from in-kind assistance to distribution of vouchers to purchase seeds, fertilizers and pesticides, assisting about 560 000 farmers.



Notes: Includes rice in milled terms. Split years refer to individual crop marketing years (for rice, calendar year of second year shown).

Lower year-on-year maize prices discouraged plantings of 2025 minor season maize crops

Planting operations of the minor season maize crops, that account for about 20 percent of the annual production, are currently underway and production is expected at a nearaverage level. Sown area is expected to be below average and lower than

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
The Republic of El Salvador

Reference Date: 29-April-2024

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Main 2024 season maize crop to be planted from May**
- **Cereal output estimated to be slightly below average in 2023**
- **Cereal import requirements, mostly maize and wheat, anticipated at high levels in 2023/24**
- **Prices of white maize and red beans below year-earlier levels in March 2024**

Main 2024 season maize crop to be planted from May

Planting of the 2024 main *primera* season maize crop is expected to start in May. Official forecasts point to above-average rainfall amounts between May and August, improving soil moisture conditions after below-average rain amounts during the first quarter of 2024 and generally favouring crop development. However, if excessive rains materialize during crop maturation or harvesting stages, they could diminish yields and constrain harvesting operations. In addition, hotter-than-average temperatures are forecast in some areas throughout the main cropping season, elevating risks for pest infestations. La Niña phenomenon is forecast to prevail from the period August-October 2024 to December 2024-February 2025. The 2024 hurricane season (from June to November) is preliminarily forecast to be more active than average, and thus a close monitoring is required.

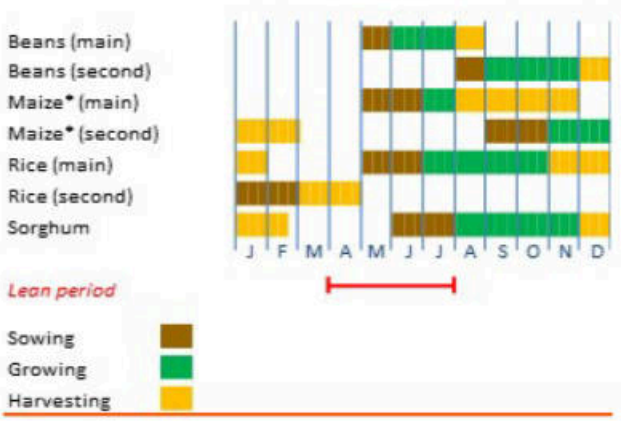
Planting area of the 2024 main maize crop is forecast at an average level. Favourable weather conditions and stable fertilizer prices, due to the continued zero tariffs on fertilizer imports, are likely to offset the negative planting intentions that may arise from lower year-on-year prices of white maize. In order to improve small-scale farmers' access to agricultural inputs, the government will start distributing vouchers of USD 75 to 560 000 small-holder farmers from mid-May 2024, with which they can purchase seeds of maize, beans and horticulture crops, and other inputs such as fertilizers and insecticides.

Cereal output estimated to be slightly below average in 2023

Cereal production in 2023 is estimated at about 880 000 tonnes, slightly below the five-year average, as a result of the prolonged dry spells during the *primera* season and the passage of tropical storm Pilar at end-October 2023 in the western part of the country. The adverse weather conditions had a negative impact

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2018-2022 average	2022	2023 estimate	change 2023/2022
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	780	788	770	-2.3
Sorghum	106	108	100	-7.2
Rice (paddy)	22	15	11	-25.1
Total	908	911	881	-3.3

Note: Percentage change calculated from unrounded data.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
The Republic of El Salvador

Reference Date: 19-June-2023

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Dry weather conditions affecting ongoing planting of 2023 main maize crops**
- **Cereal import requirements, mostly yellow maize and wheat, anticipated at high levels in 2022/23**
- **Prices of white maize and red beans above year-earlier levels in May**

Dry weather conditions affecting ongoing planting of 2023 main maize crops

Planting of the 2023 main season maize crops started in June, with a delay of one month, and it is ongoing at a slow pace due to soil moisture deficits. Satellite imagery indicates poor crop conditions in central and eastern areas (red areas in VHI map), where maize cultivation is concentrated. Planted area to the main maize crop is forecast at a below-average level, due to the current dryness as well as to persistently high production costs, albeit lower year-on-year. However, precipitation amounts are forecast to increase from July onwards, which is likely to have positive effects on yields. Rainfall during the third trimester is forecast to be near average. In addition, if the current soil moisture deficit is fully covered by improved rains in the coming months, it is likely that sowings of second season crops, expected to take place in September, will increase.

In order to improve production capacity of smallholder farmers, the Ministry of Agriculture and Livestock is distributing free maize seeds and fertilizers to more than 500 000 farmers, with a total budget of USD 38 million.

Cereal import requirements, mostly yellow maize and wheat, anticipated at high levels in 2022/23

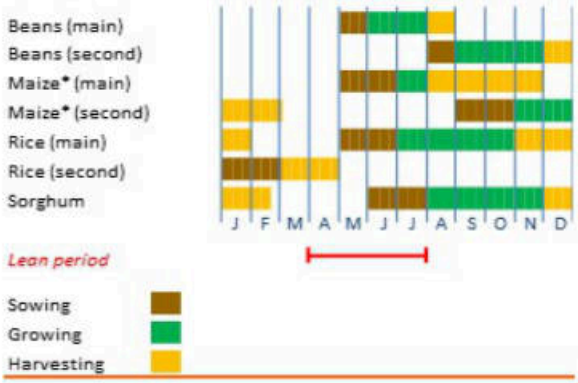
Cereal import requirements in the 2022/23 marketing year (September/August) are anticipated at high levels of 1.2 million tonnes. The high level mainly reflects strong demand of wheat for human consumption and maize by the feed industry.

Prices of white maize and red beans above year-earlier levels in May

Prices of white maize weakened between March and May 2023, due to improved supply from larger year-on-year imports during the first four months of the year. However, prices in May were still

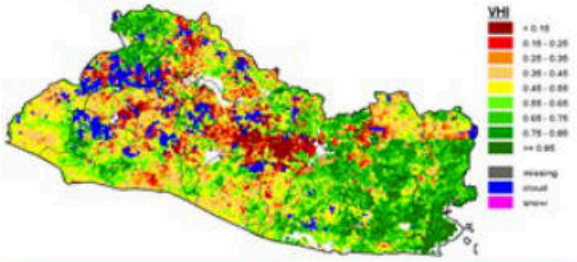
El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



El Salvador - Vegetation Health Index (VHI)

Dekad 1, June 2023



El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2018-2022 average	2022	2023 forecast	change 2023/2022
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	795	850	830	-2.4
Sorghum	103	95	90	-5.3
Rice (paddy)	22	16	15	-8.5
Total	920	961	935	-2.7

Note: Percentage change calculated from unrounded data.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 19-August-2022

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Conditions of 2022 main maize crop generally favourable**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2022/23 anticipated at slightly above-average levels driven by strong demand**
- **Prices of white maize and red beans well above their levels a year earlier in July**
- **High international prices of food and fertilizers are likely to affect food insecurity levels**

Conditions of the 2022 main maize crop generally favourable

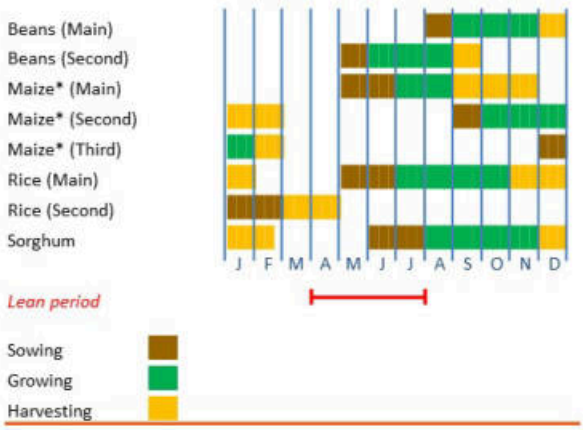
The 2022 main season maize crop is at flowering and grain-filling stages and will be harvested from September. Good seasonal rains between April and mid-June bolstered initial prospects for yields, which were slightly curbed by reduced precipitation in July. Although there is no official estimate on planted area of the main season crops, the association of small and medium producers estimated sowings had declined year on year, on accounts of high costs of agricultural inputs. To contain negative effects of rising production costs, the government distributed certified maize seeds and fertilizers to 600 000 farmers. In addition, in June 2022 the National Assembly approved a new temporary function of the government-affiliated National Centre for Agricultural and Forestry Technology (CENTA) to guarantee availability of agricultural inputs, applicable until the end of 2023. CENTA will directly purchase fertilizers and sell to farmers at a discounted price, and the first purchase of 10 000 tonnes of fertilizers is planned.

According to satellite imagery, as of early August, conditions of the main maize crop are generally favourable (see green areas in VHI map) except some localized areas in the western part of the country. Weather forecasts point to the above-average precipitation in the August-October period and an active hurricane season, which lasts until November. If torrential rains materialize at the crop maturation or harvest period, it is likely to affect yields. However, abundant precipitation in August could favour land preparation of the 2022 minor season crops.

Cereal import requirements in 2022/23

El Salvador

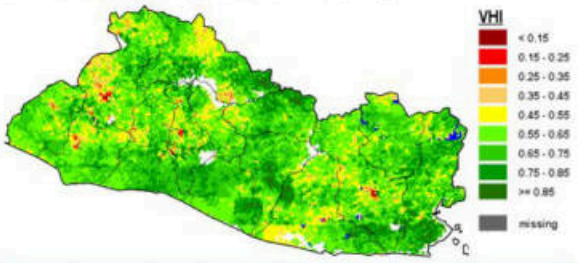
Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador - Vegetation Health Index (VHI)

from start of season 1 to dekad 1, August 2022



Source: FAO/GIEWS Earth Observation System.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 18-October-2021

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Maize production in 2021 anticipated at above-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2021/22 forecast slightly above average**
- **Prices of white maize more than 15 percent higher year on year in September**

Maize production in 2021 anticipated at above-average level

Planting of the 2021 minor season maize crop is ongoing in the eastern region, where this season's production is concentrated. Soil moisture conditions are currently adequate and rainfall amounts are forecast at average levels in the November 2021 to January 2022 period, raising yield prospects. According to official forecast, the planted area with the minor season maize crop is expected to exceed the average, as farmers are encouraged to expand plantings by high prices of the grain and good soil moisture.

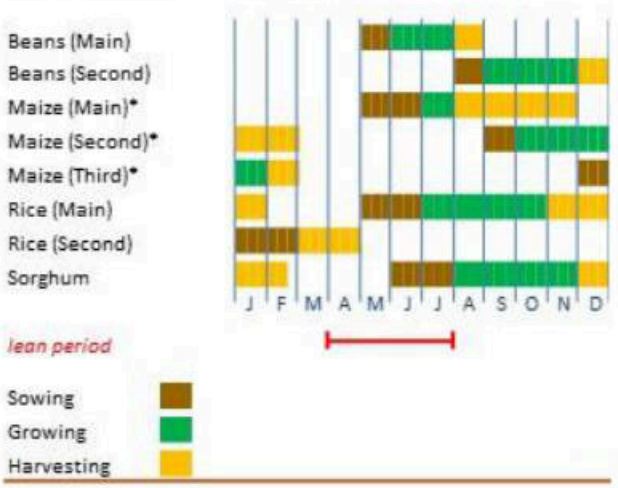
The harvest of the 2021 main season maize crop was completed at the end of September. Production is officially estimated at 880 000 tonnes, well above the average due to large plantings and above-average yields. Although the temporal distribution of seasonal rains was mostly erratic, the accumulated rainfall amounts were near the average and favoured a normal crop development. The government distributed improved seeds and fertilizers to about 400 000 farmers. Overall, the 2021 maize production is anticipated at an above-average level of 1.1 million tonnes, including a forecast of the output of the minor season crops.

Cereal import requirements in 2021/22 forecast slightly above average

Cereal import requirements in the 2021/22 marketing year (September/August) are forecast at about 1.1 million tonnes, slightly exceeding the five-year average. The requirements of maize imports, which account for about two-thirds of total imports, are anticipated at average levels. Regarding wheat, the country entirely depends on imports to cover the domestic demand for human consumption. Wheat imports requirements in 2021/22 are forecast slightly above the average as the strong annual domestic demand is partially offset by large carryover stocks from a year earlier.

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2016-2020 average	2020	2021 forecast	change 2021/2020
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	845	886	986	11.4
Sorghum	109	105	110	4.4
Rice (paddy)	27	28	35	24.5
Total	981	1 019	1 131	11.0

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 27-April-2021

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Land preparation for sowing of 2021 main season maize crop ongoing**
- **Cereal production in 2020 officially estimated at above-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2020/21 forecast at high levels**
- **Prices of white maize nearly 15 percent lower year on year in March**

Land preparation for sowing of 2021 main season maize crop ongoing

Ahead of the start of the 2021 main season maize crop, land preparation is ongoing under favourable weather conditions. The weather forecast points to average precipitation and temperature in the May-July period, which coincides with crop development and flowering stages, boosting prospects for crop yields. In early April, Central American locusts (*Schistocerca piceifrons*) were reported in the central department of San Vicente, but the implementation of timely measures by the Ministry of Agriculture successfully controlled the outbreak.

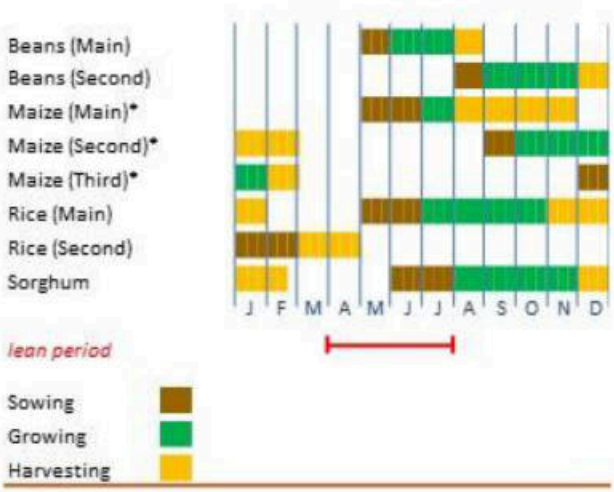
Cereal production in 2020 officially estimated at above-average level

The 2020 cereal production is officially estimated at a well above-average level of 1 million tonnes, with maize accounting for nearly 90 percent. The above-average maize output in 2020 is mainly due to excellent yields, reflecting favourable weather conditions. The passage of Tropical Storm Amanda in June 2020 and hurricanes Eta and Iota in November 2020 had only a marginal impact on maize crop production. The 2020 sorghum production is estimated at 105 000 tonnes, a slightly below-average level due to the reduced planted area in favour of more profitable crops.

Production of beans in 2020 is estimated at 132 500 tonnes, with a year-on-year increase of about 30 percent. The large output reflects above-average yields, which were obtained partially due to the use of improved seeds that were distributed by the Ministry of Agriculture to about 223 000 farmers.

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2015-2019 average	2019	2020 estimate	change 2020/2019
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	813	795	886	11.3
Sorghum	108	109	105	-3.4
Rice (paddy)	32	28	35	25.0
Total	953	933	1 026	10.0

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 20-August-2020

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Maize output in 2020 forecast at above-average level due to good yields**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2020/21 forecast at above-average level**
- **Following upsurge in March-June period, prices of red beans and rice remained well above year-earlier levels**

Maize output in 2020 forecast at above-average level due to good yields

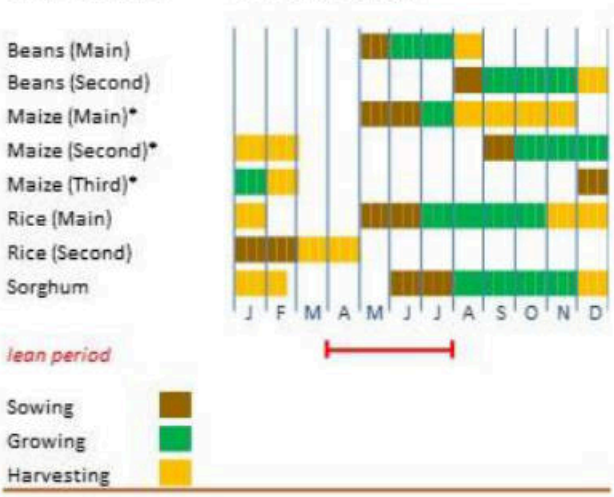
Harvesting of the 2020 main season maize crop, which accounts for about 80 percent of the annual production, is ongoing under favourable weather conditions. Good yields are expected as favourable rainfall in the May-July period benefitted crop development. The passage of Tropical Storm Amanda in early June did not have a severe impact on the maize crop and the affected crops in the western region were successfully replanted within the planting window. In order to boost production of the 2020 main maize crop, the Ministry of Agriculture distributed free seeds and fertilizers across the country between the end of April and early June to 400 000 farmers, marking an annual increase in beneficiaries of 30 percent. Although there is no official estimate of plantings, high domestic prices and good soil moisture during the planting period are likely to have instigated an increase in the area.

Planting operations of the 2020 minor season maize crop, to be harvested in November and December, are underway. The localized outbreak of Central American locusts (Schistocerca piceifrons) in the central and eastern regions was successfully contained as of mid-August due to effective control measures and no major crop losses were reported. Assuming normal minor season conditions, the aggregate 2020 maize output is forecast at 920 000 tonnes, about 10 percent higher than the previous five-year average.

The Ministry of Agriculture started the free distribution of improved bean seeds in mid-August for ongoing planting operations of the main bean season. The target is expected to reach 223 000 farmers across the country.

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2015-2019 average	2019	2020 forecast	change 2020/2019
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	828	870	920	5.7
Sorghum	108	110	120	9.1
Rice (paddy)	33	35	29	-17.1
Total	969	1 015	1 069	5.3

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 05-May-2020

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Forecasts of adequate seasonal rains increase prospects for 2020 main season maize crop**
- **Cereal production in 2019 estimated at average level**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2019/20 forecast slightly above average**
- **Prices of maize, red beans and rice increased in March amid COVID-19 pandemic**

Forecasts of adequate seasonal rains increase prospects for 2020 main season maize crop

Land preparation of the 2020 main season maize crop is ongoing across the country and planting operations will start in mid-May. The current pre-rainy season, characterized by downpours and thunderstorms, will continue until mid-May, when the start of seasonal rains is officially forecast. Precipitations during the May-July period are forecast to be adequate and are expected to benefit yields. The Ministry of Agriculture started the free distribution of maize seeds and fertilizers in the Western Region, where the onset of the rains is earlier than in other parts of the country. As an effort to boost production, the Government has increased the number of beneficiaries by 30 percent compared to the previous year, targeting 400 000 farmers.

Cereal production in 2019 estimated at average level

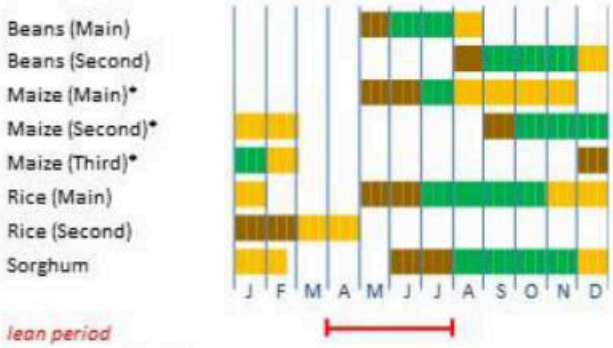
Production of cereal in 2019 is estimated at an average level of 955 000 tonnes, more than 85 percent of which corresponds to maize. The maize output increased from the drought-affected output in 2018 and remained at near-average levels. An increase in plantings due to high prices and beneficial weather conditions at planting time was offset by low yields due to dry weather conditions during the critical flowering and grain-filling phases. Sorghum production in 2019 is estimated at a below-average level of 100 000 tonnes due to torrential rains in October that negatively affected yields. In addition, plantings of sorghum have declined as the feed industry is shifting to imported yellow maize, lowering demand for locally-produced sorghum.

Cereal import requirements in 2019/20 forecast slightly above average

Cereal import requirements in the 2019/20 marketing year (September/August) are forecast at about 1.1 million tonnes, slightly above the previous five-year average, reflecting a

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2014-2018 average	2018	2019 estimate	change 2019/2018
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	809	686	820	19.6
Sorghum	115	109	100	-8.5
Rice (paddy)	34	34	35	3.2
Total	958	829	955	15.2

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 28-October-2019

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Maize production in 2019 expected at near-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2018/19 forecast to increase**
- **In October, prices of maize and beans higher than year-earlier levels**

Maize production in 2019 expected at near-average level

Harvesting of the 2019 main season maize crop, which accounts for about 80 percent of the annual production, finalized in late September. The season was characterized by heavy rains that were more than 50 percent above the long-term average at the planting period in May, followed by dry weather conditions in the June-July period, which corresponds to crop development and flowering stages. The eastern region experienced some soil moisture deficits, but the impact of reduced rainfall on the main season crops is expected to have a limited impact at the national aggregate level, as maize production in the east is concentrated in the second season. Production of the 2019 main maize crop is estimated at a near-average level as the negative effects of unfavourable rain on yields have been offset by enlarged plantings, instigated by higher prices at the planting period.

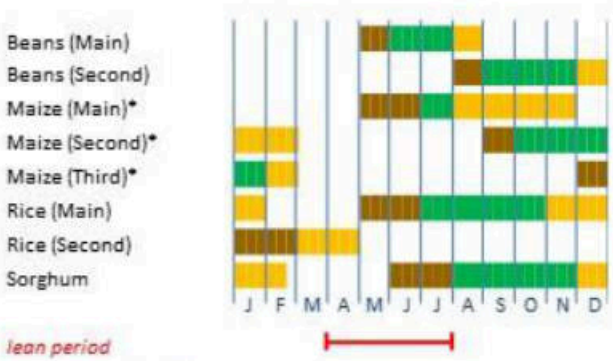
Planting of the 2019 minor season maize crop has recently completed, in early October, with some delay, due to above-average rainfalls in the key producing departments of San Miguel and La Unión. Given favourable weather forecasts until early 2020 and the low probability of an El Niño phenomenon occurrence, production of the minor season maize crop, to be harvested in January, is anticipated to be slightly above the average.

The aggregate 2019 maize production is anticipated at an average level of 835 000 tonnes.

The 2019 sorghum production is anticipated at the below-average level of 100 000 tonnes as torrential rains in September and October negatively affected yields. In addition, plantings of sorghum have declined as the feed industry is shifting to imported yellow maize, lowering demand for locally-produced sorghum.

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2014-2018 average	2018	2019 estimate	change 2019/2018
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	827	780	835	7.1
Sorghum	111	90	100	11.1
Rice (paddy)	34	34	35	3.2
Total	972	904	970	7.3

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 16-November-2018

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Cereal production in 2018 anticipated at below-average level due to prolonged dry spells**
- **Cereal import requirements in 2018/19 forecast to increase**
- **Prices of maize and beans higher than year-earlier levels in October**

Cereal production in 2018 anticipated at below-average level due to prolonged dry spells

The aggregate 2018 cereal production is anticipated at 950 000 tonnes, slightly lower than the previous five-year average, mainly due to a decline in maize production.

Planting of the 2018 *postrera* season maize crop finalized in September and harvesting operations are expected to start in January. The aggregate 2018 maize production is anticipated at a below-average level of 830 000 tonnes, reflecting unfavourable weather conditions during the *primera* season. The prolonged dry spells from June to early-August affected 112 municipalities of 10 departments, particularly in the eastern region, where 29 consecutive days with no rainfall were recorded. It is officially estimated that the drought caused 45 000 tonnes of *primera* season maize crop losses, which represents about 4 percent of the 2018/19 production target. In August, the Government distributed certified seeds and fertilizers in order to allow the affected farmers to replant and limit the losses. Additional crop losses were triggered by torrential rains during the first half of October, which were officially estimated at 8 400 tonnes of *postrera* season maize crop.

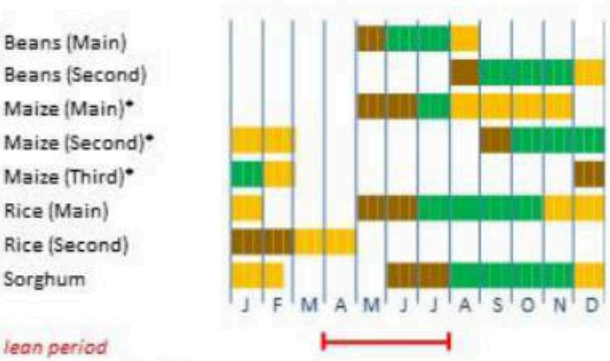
The 2018 sorghum production is expected at 95 000 tonnes, near last year's production. The crop is more resistant to dry weather conditions, however, some crops werre lost due to the torrential rains in October.

Cereal import requirements in 2018/19 forecast to increase

Reflecting lower domestic availabilities and a sustained demand from the poultry sector, cereal import requirements in the 2018/19 marketing year (September/August) are forecast to increase by 12 percent from the last five-year average and reach 1 million tonnes.

El Salvador

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS.

El Salvador

Cereal Production

	2013-2017 average	2017	2018 estimate	change 2018/2017
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	845	904	830	-8.2
Sorghum	121	96	95	-1.3
Rice (paddy)	34	26	25	-3.8
Total	1 000	1 026	950	-7.4

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 30-June-2017

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Cereal production in 2017 anticipated to remain at last year's high level**
- **Cereal imports forecast to sharply decline in 2017/18 marketing year**
- **Prices of maize and beans remained at low levels in June**

Cereal production in 2017 anticipated to remain at last year's high level

Planting of the main 2017 cereal season is virtually concluded. Sowing operations benefitted from the good precipitation levels, even in the "dry corridor". Continued provisions of agricultural inputs by the Government and an anticipation that rainfall levels will be normal, as the risk for an El Niño event has diminished, should maintain plantings at last year's high level. FAO's preliminary forecast, which assumes favourable weather conditions for the rest of the year, is for cereal output to reach almost 1.1 million tonnes in 2017, well above the country's five-average.

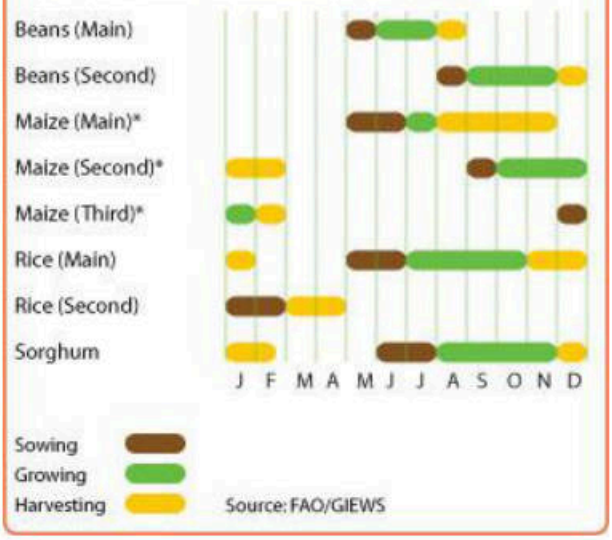
Cereal imports forecast to sharply decline in 2017/18 marketing year

Cereal imports in the 2017/18 marketing year (September/August) are forecast to decline sharply from the high levels of the previous years when outputs were reduced by drought. The decline is being driven by ample cereal supplies, particularly of maize, due to the bumper 2016 crop. Imports may decline further for 2017/18 if crop yields for the current crop result as high as forecasted.

Prices of maize and beans remained at low levels in June

Reflecting the 2016 bumper maize crop and the good prospects for the 2017 first season crop, to be harvested from late August, prices continued their declining trend from the previous months in June and were some 37 percent below their level from a year earlier. Prices of red beans, the main staple, were stable in June after increasing the previous month, mainly reflecting imports. Prices, however, remained below their level from a year earlier.

El Salvador
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



El Salvador
Cereal production

	2012-2016 average	2016	2017 forecast	change 2017/2016
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	841	900	900	0
Sorghum	132	141	140	-1
Rice (paddy)	36	37	38	3
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	1 010	1 078	1 078	0

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
El Salvador

Reference Date: 02-December-2016

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Cereal production in 2016 anticipated to recover from last year's drought-reduced level**
- **Cereal imports forecast to decline in 2016/17 marketing year (September/August)**
- **Maize and rice prices continued to decline in November, while bean prices increased seasonally**

Cereal production in 2016 anticipated to recover from last year's drought-reduced level

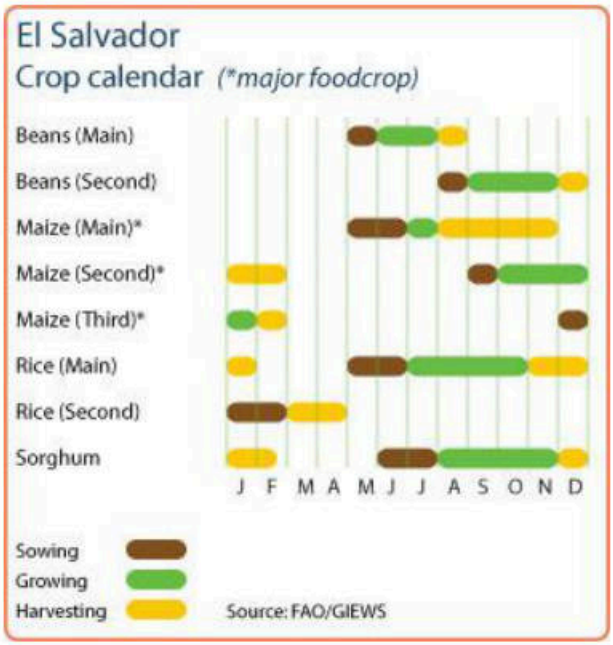
Cereal production in 2016 is forecast to reach 1 million tonnes, a 25 percent increase over last year's drought-reduced level. The anticipated increase in cereal output mainly reflects a recovery in maize production. Harvest of the main "de primera" season, which represents some 60 percent of the annual maize output, concluded in October. Preliminary official estimates point to a good outcome for the season. Planting of the secondary crop also concluded in October and prospects are favourable, as weather conditions were good and farmers received inputs from the Government, including seeds and fertilizers. The official forecast for the maize crop production in 2016 point to 850 000 tonnes, a bumper level. The 2016 rice crop production is forecast to decline some 5 percent from last year's good level and reach 37 000 tonnes, as the secondary season was affected by dry weather conditions. However, at this level, output will remain above average.

Cereal imports forecast to decline in 2016/17 marketing year

Cereal imports in the 2016/17 marketing year (September/August) are forecast to decline sharply from last year's record level, reflecting the positive outlook for the 2016 cereal production. The bulk of the decline stems from lower maize imports for the 2016/17 marketing year (September/August), which are anticipated at 430 000 tonnes, down 38 percent year-on-year.

Maize and rice prices continued to decline in November, bean prices increased seasonally

Wholesale prices of white maize in November continued their declining trend of the previous months and were some 21 percent below their levels from a year earlier reflecting ample supplies from the good main season harvest concluded in October. Rice prices also declined from the previous month and from a year



El Salvador

Cereal production

	2011-2015 average	2015	2016 forecast	change 2016/2015
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	814	682	850	25
Sorghum	145	160	141	-12
Rice (paddy)	34	39	37	-5
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	993	881	1 028	17

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 30-December-2015

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Cereal production in 2015 reduced by drought for second consecutive year**
- **Cereal imports forecast at record level for 2015/16 marketing year (July/June)**
- **Maize and bean prices continue to decline in December**

Cereal production in 2015 reduced by drought for second consecutive year

Cereal production in 2015 has been preliminarily estimated at 836 000 tonnes, some 14 percent below last year's already drought-reduced output. For a second consecutive year the main "de primera" agricultural season (May/September) was significantly affected by a prolonged dry weather weather, associated with the El Niño phenomenon. Production of maize , the main cereal grown in the country, is estimated some 18 percent below last year's level and well below the five-year average. To mitigate the production decreases, the Government has allowed increased maize imports at a zero tariff from outside the Central American region, mainly from the United States of America and Mexico. Similarly, rice production in 2015 is estimated to decrease by 4 percent from last year's reduced level and some 13 percent less than the average.

Cereal imports forecast at record levels for 2015/16 marketing year (July/June)

Cereal imports in the 2015/16 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at 938 000 tonnes or 9 percent up from last year's already high level. The increase is largely due to near-record maize imports, as a result of this year's reduced output. Rice imports are expected to increase moderately, while wheat imports are set to remain stable at 260 000 tonnes.

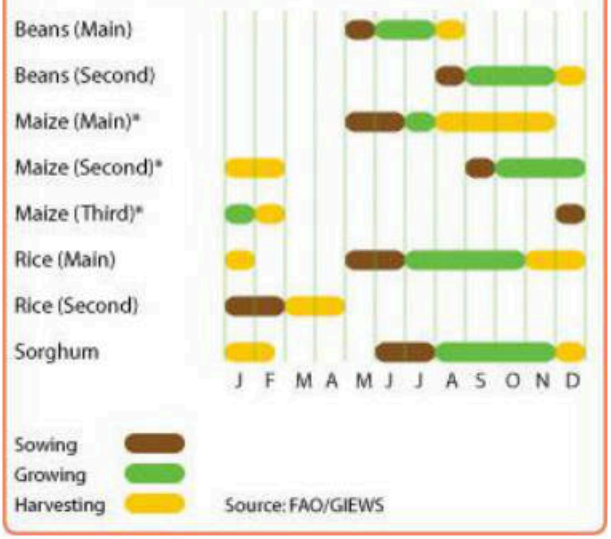
Maize and bean prices continue to decline in December

Wholesale prices of white maize continued to decrease in December reflecting adequate availabilities from the recently completed main harvest and imports from Mexico, the subregion's main producer, as well as imports from the United States of America. The onset of the second season maize harvest also added to the downward pressure. Prices, however, remained above their levels a year earlier, supported by the reduced first season outputs.

Bean prices in December continued to decline and were below their year-earlier levels. Ample availabilities from recent imports, and supplies from the 2015 first and second season harvests pushed red bean prices down to levels well below those of a year earlier.

El Salvador

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



El Salvador

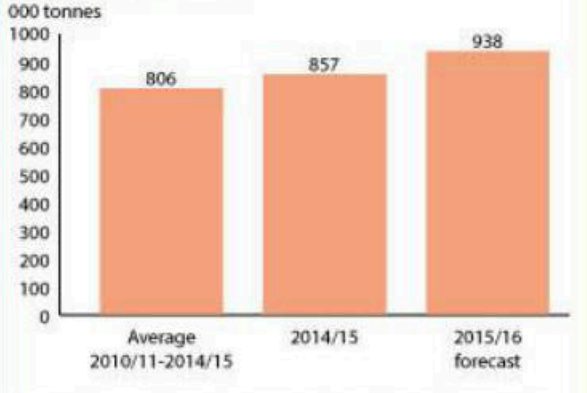
Cereal production

	2010-2014 average	2014	2015 forecast	change 2015/2014
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	829	790	650	-18
Sorghum	138	160	160	0
Rice (paddy)	30	27	26	-4
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	998	977	836	-14

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador

Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 04-March-2014

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Early estimates point to an increase in 2013 maize and bean production
- Cereal imports forecast to rise in 2013/14 (July/June) on demand from feed sector
- Bean prices surged in February while maize prices remained low

Early estimates point to an increase in 2013 maize and bean production

Harvesting of the 2013/14 second "de postrera" and third "de apante" maize and beans seasons are virtually completed. Good outputs are anticipated due to favourable weather and the Government's provision of supplemental technology packages in response to reduced yields of the main cropping season "de primera", gathered until December last year, due to severe dry weather. Preliminary estimates point to an 2013/14 aggregate maize production of 953 000 tonnes, a new record level. Production of maize in the last two years has been increasing primarily due to the Government's production support programmes, which consist in the distribution of improved seeds, fertilizers and the provision of extension services.

A good production of the 2013/14 bean crop is also expected. All three seasons (de primera, postrera, and apante) were favoured by relatively good weather. Like for maize, the Government has prodived technology packages to support production. Preliminary official estimates point to an 8 percent increase in the output from 2012 to 127 000 tonnes.

Cereal imports forecast to rise in 2013/14 (July/June) on demand from feed sector

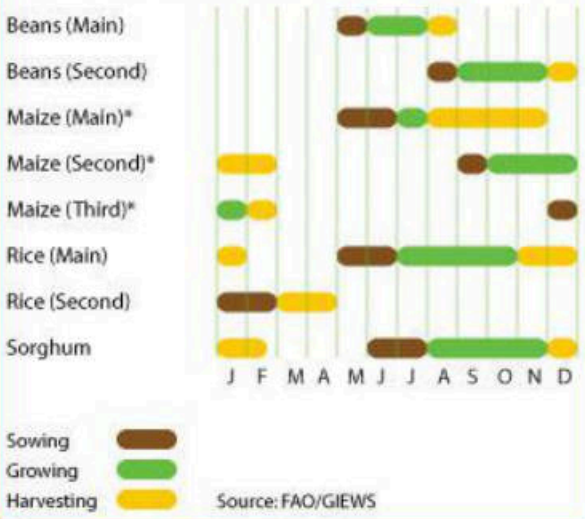
Cereal imports in the 2013/14 marketing year (July/June) are forecast to reach 750 000 tonnes or 8 percent up from last year's reduced level. This increase has been revised downward from earlier projections due to better than expected production. The increase primarily reflects high demand for yellow maize from the feed industry. Wheat imports are also forecast to marginally increase.

Bean prices surged in February while maize prices remained low

Notwithstanding the increase in local bean production, prices in El Salvador surged 23 percent in February and were 18 percent higher than at the same time last year. Prices were supported by a significantly reduced regional output following poor bean crops in Nicaragua and Honduras, the country's main suppliers of beans.

By contrast, wholesale white maize prices seasonally increased 5 percent from January but remained lower than in February 2013. The low maize price reflects the ample supplies in the market from last year's bumper crop.

El Salvador
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*

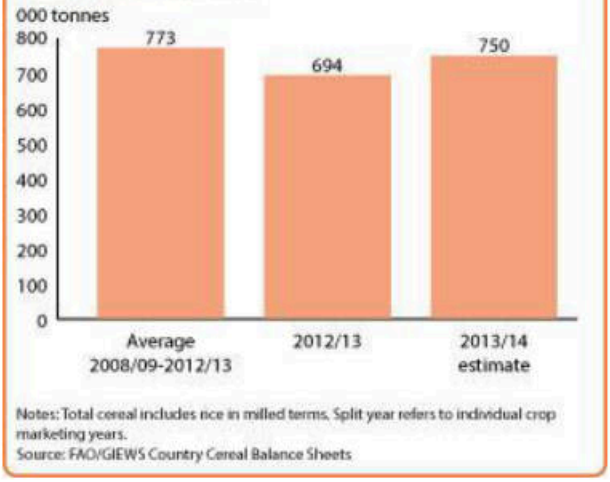


El Salvador
Cereal production

	2008-2012 average	2012	2013 forecast	change 2013/2012
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	828	934	952	2
Sorghum	150	140	144	3
Rice (paddy)	30	28	31	11
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	1 008	1 102	1 127	2

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador
Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 07-October-2013

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- 2013 main season maize production decreases
- Coffee leaf rust continues to affect food security in rural areas
- Maize and bean prices at relatively low levels

2013 main season maize production decreases

Harvesting of the 2013 main season maize crop has concluded. The prolonged dry weather, known as the canicula, during the month of July, negatively affected yileds particularly in the departments of San Miguel, Usulutàm and Unión, which together account for about 20 percent of national maize production. Preliminary estimates point to a 4 percent reduction in the main season maize production compared to the previous year. Sowing of the second "de postrera" season was completed in late September under favourable weather conditions. The Minsitry of Agriculture delivered additional technology packages to the dry weather affected areas to sustain production during this season. Harvest prospects are generally good. Total 2013 maize production ("primera and "postrera") is forecast to reach 900 000 tonnes, below last year's record levels but still above agerage.

Coffee leaf rust continues to affect food security in rural areas

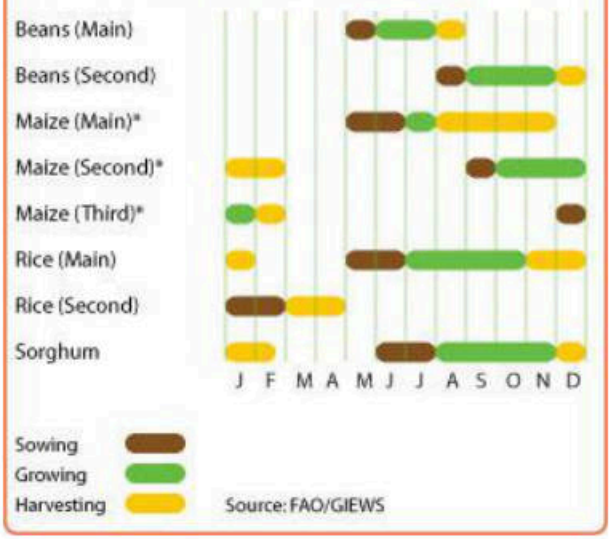
Coffee production was severely affected by the coffee leaf rust during the 2012/13 (October/March) season and early official forecasts point to a 36 percent decline in 2013/2014 coffee production with respect to the previous year. According to a preliminary assesment carried out by WFP in May, more than 65 000 farmers, who depend on the coffee sector as their main source of employment income, were affected by the coffee leaf rust. In response, food packages will be distributed until the end of November to 10 000 households.

Maize and bean prices at relatively low levels

In September, prices of maize and beans, the two main staple foods in the local diet, strengthened with respect to the previous month. The rise in prices is due to the effects of the canícula on the main season harvest. However, reflecting high supplies on the market, maize and bean prices are 3 and 30 percent below their levels of September 2012 respectively.

El Salvador

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



El Salvador

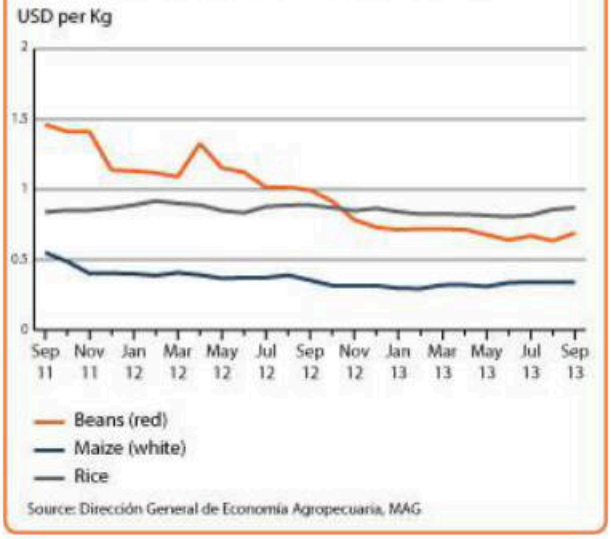
Cereal production

	2008-2012 average	2012	2013 forecast	change 2013/2012
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	828	934	900	-4
Sorghum	150	140	144	3
Rice (paddy)	30	28	31	11
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	1 008	1 102	1 075	-2

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador

Wholesale food prices in San Salvador



GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 28-February-2012

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- 2011 maize production above average despite second season losses
- Bean prices drop with the "de postrera" harvest

Good grain production in 2011 despite losses caused by torrential rainfall in October

The 2010-11 second and third season crops (the "de postrera" and "de apante" seasons) are currently being harvested under favourable weather conditions. Last October the country was hit by tropical depression 12-E, which brought torrential rainfall causing localized crop losses in the "de postrera" season. Estimated losses include 16 000 tonnes of beans and 45 000 tonnes of maize (6 percent of annual production), as well as 10 000 tonnes of sorghum and 4 000 tonnes rice. To mitigate the impact of these losses, the Government provided incentives for re-sowing maize and beans by making agricultural inputs available. This should make it possible to harvest additional 24 000 tonnes of maize and 3 900 tonnes of beans. As a result of the re-sowing and good harvest obtained in the main season, total maize production in 2011 (main, second and third seasons) is forecast at 786 million tonnes, slightly above both last year's level and the average of the last five years.

FAO launched a program to support farmers affected by the rains, by providing bean and vegetable seeds, fertilizers, insecticides and metal containers for food storage, for a total value of USD 400 000.

The Government also authorized duty-free importation of 2 300 tonnes of maize and 1 150 tonnes of beans, to guarantee supplies to the population and keep prices stable on local market.

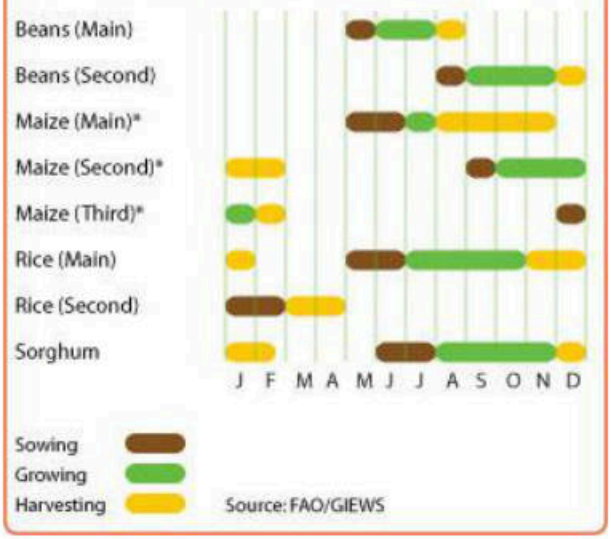
Cereal import requirements to decline in 2011/12 (July/June)

Cereal import requirement for 2011/12 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at 757 000 tonnes or 5 percent below last year's level as a result of the higher output estimated in 2011.

Prices of basic foods at record levels

In the national capital, San Salvador, maize and bean prices decreased from their mid-2011 record levels, from September onwards as the 2011 main harvest came in. Prices then dropped further in the new year, in the wake of the government's re-sowing programmes; and in January 2012, bean prices were 44 percent below their January 2011 levels. In the case of maize, of which 40 percent of domestic consumption is imported, prices in January were around the

El Salvador
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



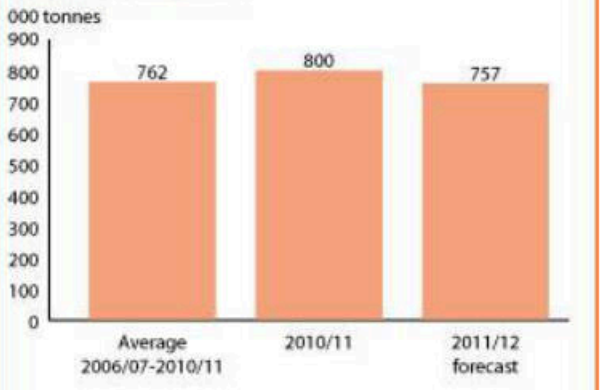
Source: FAO/GIEWS

El Salvador
Cereal production

	2006-2010 average	2010	2011 forecast	change 2011/2010
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	774	777	786	1
Sorghum	164	108	134	24
Rice (paddy)	31	35	34	-3
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	970	920	954	4

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador
Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 30-May-2011

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Uncertain prospects for the sowing of the 2011first season cereal crops
- Excessive rainfall reduced 2010 maize and bean production
- Prices of maize and beans at record levels

Sowing prospects uncertain for cereal crops of the 2011 main season

Sowing of the 2011 main cereal crops has begun. After the weakening of the La Niña phenomenon, from February to April, a return to normal conditions is forecast for the next few months. The rainy season began as normal in mid-May, but rainfall has been irregular and below average, leading to losses of crops, especially maize, sown early. In order to encourage production during the season, the Government is supplying seeds and fertilizers to 325 000 vulnerable families but more rainfall is needed to avoid further losses and reseeding.

Significant reduction in cereal production in 2010

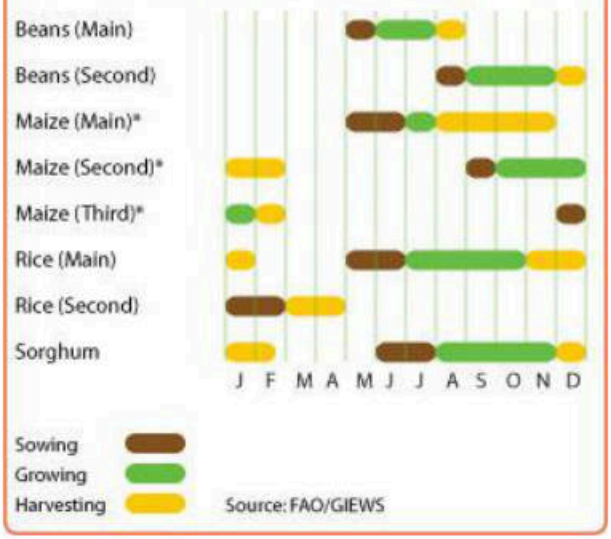
During the 2010/11 “primera” and "postrera" agricultural seasons, excessive rainfall was recorded due to the passage of tropical storms Agatha and Matthew. The Ministry of Agriculture reported losses of USD 96.3 million in the agricultural and livestock farming sectors, USD 69 million of which was due to the losses of basic grains. Total production of cereals is estimated to be 9 percent lower than in 2009 and 11 percent lower compared to the average for the last five years. In particular, sorghum production experienced a significant decline due to excessive humidity - an estimated 37 percent reduction compared to average production over the last five years. Bean crops were one of the crops most affected by the excessive humidity throughout 2010.

Prices of basic foods at record levels

In March 2011, prices of maize and beans, the country's basic foods, reached record levels and were 40 percent higher than in March 2010. The increase in the price of maize is due to the reduced 2010 harvest and the high prices on the international market. In addition, prices of beans in March were 133 percent higher than last year although they fell from the record levels reached in November 2010. As regards beans, in addition to the reduced yield in 2010, the increase in prices reflects the reduced harvest throughout the Central American region, and particularly Nicaragua, the main exporter in the subregion.

El Salvador

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



El Salvador

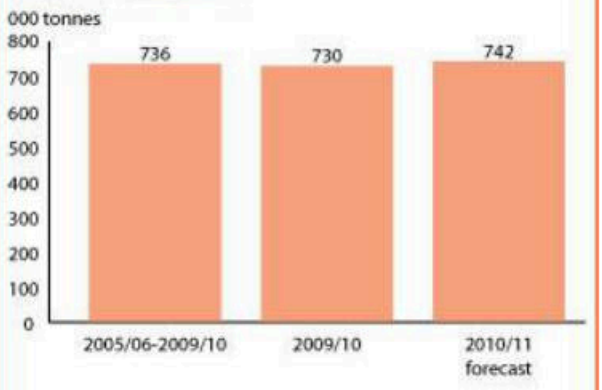
Cereal production

	2005-2009 average	2009	2010 estimate	change 2010/2009
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	815	795	767	-4
Sorghum	171	166	108	-35
Rice (paddy)	30	36	31	-14
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	1016	997	906	-9

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador

Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 5-March-2011

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Cereals and beans of the 2010 second season have been harvested
- The damages caused by excessive rainfall to maize and bean crops in 2010 led to increased prices in local markets
- It is likely that the sowing of crops in the first season of 2011, which will take place in May/June, will continue to be affected by the La Niña phenomenon

La Niña will continue to affect the sowing of the 2011 first season crops

The main crops of the 2010 second season have been harvested and minimal agricultural activities take place in March. It is predicted that the sowing of crops in the first season of 2011, which will begin in April/May, will continue to be affected by the La Niña phenomenon. Although the phenomenon has started to ease off, above average and irregular rainfall is forecast for the months in which the first season's crops are sown.

Significant reduction in cereal production in 2010

The country suffered the consequences of the tropical storms Matthew and Agatha during the first and second agricultural seasons. The Ministry of Agriculture reported losses of USD 96.3 million in the agricultural and livestock farming sectors, USD 69 million of which was due to the loss of basic grains. It is estimated that the total production of cereals in 2010 will decline by 9 percent compared to 2009 and 11 percent compared to the average of the last five years. In particular, sorghum production experienced a significant decline due to excessive humidity - an estimated 37 percent drop compared to the average production over the last five years. Bean crops were severely affected by the excessive humidity in 2010.

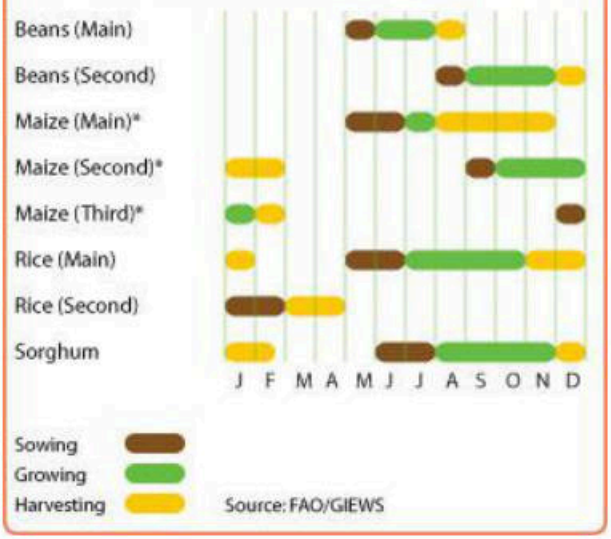
Increased import of basic grains compared to 2009

A slight increase is estimated in the importation of basic grains in the 2010/11 marketing year (August/July) compared to the levels imported in the previous year The country also normally imports 30 percent of the red beans it consumes, from Nicaragua in particular. This year, the Government has confirmed the importation of 4 500 tonnes of red beans from China.

Sharp increase in the price of red beans

A 150 percent increase in the price of red beans compared to its price in 2010 was recorded in the San Salvador local market. This sharp increase is due to the low production of this crop across Central America, and particularly in Nicaragua, which supplies the bulk of the country's bean imports. The price of maize also suffered a significant increase by 32 percent between January 2010 and January 2011. Rice is the only food staple whose price remains stable.

El Salvador
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*

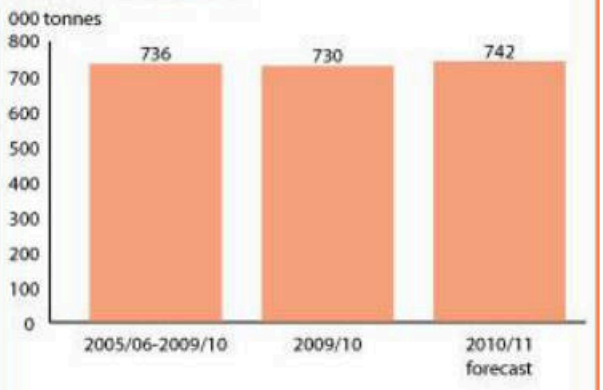


El Salvador
Cereal production

	2005-2009 average	2009	2010 estimate	change 2010/2009
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	815	795	767	-4
Sorghum	171	166	108	-35
Rice (paddy)	30	36	31	-14
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	1016	997	906	-9

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador
Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 1-December-2010

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Heavy rainfall due to hurricanes followed by dry spell in October affected crops
- Near average 2010 cereal production
- Bean production seriously affected by water logging followed by dry spell
- Sharp increase in red bean prices

Coastal and Central valley regions have been affected by excessive rainfall

Heavy rainfall during the first cropping season, from last summer, has produced water logging mainly in the Coastal and Central valley regions, affecting the moisture condition of the harvested maize and mainly bean crops. Farmers have reported approximately 10-15 percent maize-cob damage due to high moisture content. Infrastructure, main roads have also been affected seriously.

Good cereal harvest in 2010

Despite the heavy rainfall levels due to very active hurricane season, the maize production is estimated to be 18 percent above the 5-years average national maize production. Near average rice production is also expected in 2010. However the beans production, which also constitutes part of the staple diet, was affected in the first half of the cropping season by excess water and by dry spell during the flowering phase.

Imports of basic grains in 2010 are forecast to increase compared to the previous year

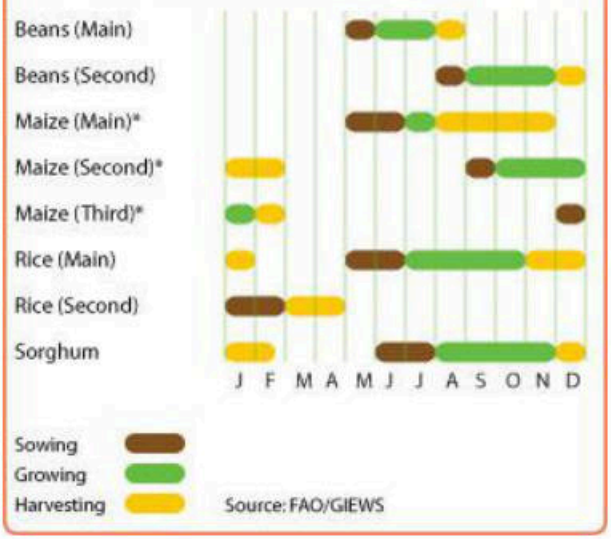
Imports of basic grains in 2010 are estimated at 630 000 tonnes, 7 percent above the previous year. The increase is mainly due to bigger import requirements of maize to offset production losses in 2009 due to adverse weather conditions.

Sharp increase of red beans price

A sharp increase was observed in red bean prices in San Salvador since last summer due to the poor 2010 bean production in the country and in the rest of Central American countries. In San Salvador, the average monthly retail price of beans during October 2010 was 2.41 USD/Kg, which is more than double the level of one year ago.

El Salvador

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



El Salvador

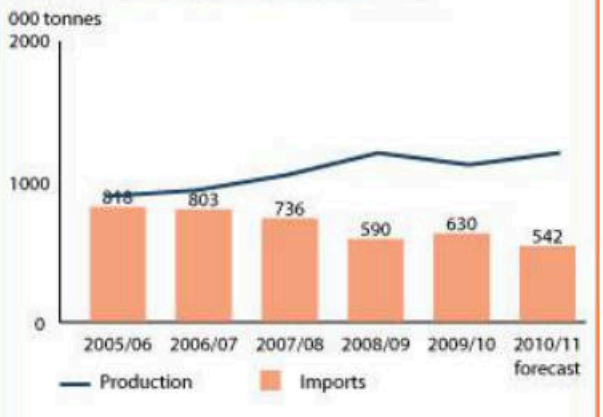
Cereal production

	2005-2009 average	2009	2010 forecast	change 2010/2009
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	836	900	990	10
Sorghum	174	184	184	0
Rice (paddy)	30	36	31	-14
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	1041	1120	1205	8

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador

Total cereal production and imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 1-October-2010

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Severe rainfall caused widespread damage and forced more than 2 000 people to be evacuated
- Harvesting of the main "primera" season crops is complete or well advanced; prospects are unfavourable for beans
- Prices of red beans increased by more than 15 percent from July to August 2010

Heavy rains caused widespread damage in the coastal and central valley regions

A yellow alert was declared by the government on 24 September 2010 across the country while the orange alert is maintained for the coastal and central valley regions and the red alert for the areas in lower parts of watersheds where the saturation of soils, due to the intense rainfall of recent weeks, is causing waterlogging.

According to official reports, more than 2 000 people have been forced from their homes and are currently receiving humanitarian assistance. Damage to infrastructure is also severe with 14 major interdepartemental roads and 5 bridges reported to have been destroyed

Harvesting of 2010 main cropping season is almost complete with favourable prospects for maize

Despite the unfavourable weather conditions brought by the particularly active hurricane season this year, the national association of producers of basic grains (PROGRANO) ensured that there will be sufficient availability of maize, the principal staple of vulnerable groups in El Salvador. Harvesting of the main (primera) maize crop is nearing completion and preliminary estimates point to a production, of the primera season, of 592 000 tonnes which, if confirmed, would represent an increase of more than 8 percent compared to the good primera harvest of 2009.

Unlike the maize crop, widespread losses are reported for the primera season bean crops that are more sensitive to excess water and waterlogging.

In 2010 imports of basic grains are forecast to increase on last year

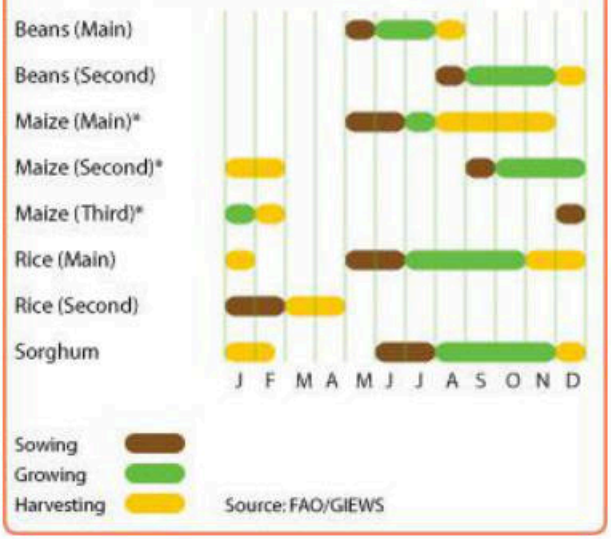
Imports of basic grains in 2010 are estimated at 630 000 tonnes, 7 percent above the previous year. The increase is mainly due to the augmented import requirements of maize to offset 2009 production losses caused by adverse weather conditions.

Maize and rice prices increase to their levels of two years ago

Following a stable trend that lasted since November 2009, where red beans quotations on the market of San Salvador were similar to pre-food crisis level, prices have started to increase again since April. In particular red beans price rose by 15 percent between June and August

El Salvador

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



El Salvador

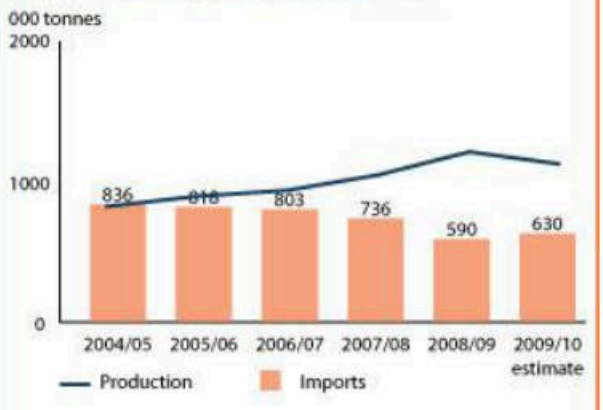
Cereal production

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Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

El Salvador

Total cereal production and imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 12-April-2010

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Imports are expected to increase due to maize and beans losses in 2009
- Prices of most important staple food are back to the level of two years ago

Heavy rains are expected at the end of April

Rainfall was generally close to average during March and part of the current month, whereas for the remainder of April, the National Weather Service forecasts abundant precipitation in the Northern part of the Western region. However, the amount of accumulated rainfall, from May to July, is expected to be below the seasonal average in most parts of the country.

Planting of 2010 main cropping season is about to start

Under generally good conditions, field work for the sowing of the 2010 cereal and bean crops is underway. Planting should begin with the imminent arrival of the first rains in May. If weather conditions will be favourable with a timely start of the rainy season, the sowed area with maize is expected to be similar to the area planted in 2009.

To support the recovery of agricultural production in areas affected by the storm Ida at the end of 2009 and in the framework of the Sistema de Protección Social Universal, the Government continues to distribute packages benefiting small scale agricultural producers.

The total area sowed with rice and beans crops is also expected to be on average.

In marketing year 2009/10 imports of basic grains are forecast to increase

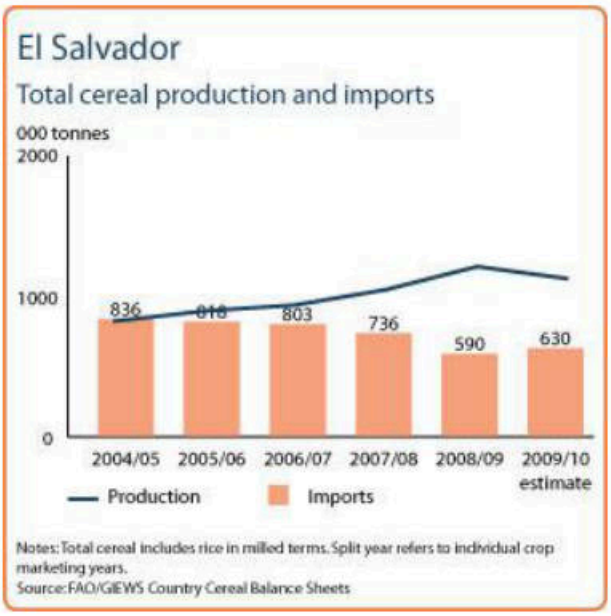
Imports of basic grains in marketing year 2009/10 are estimated at 630 000 tonnes, 7 percent above the previous year. The increase is mainly on account of the augmented import requirements of maize to offset 2009 production losses caused by adverse weather conditions.

Beans prices are declining sharply from mid-2008. Maize and rice quotations are back to the level of two years ago

The price of rice in the market of San Salvador has dropped considerably since September 2009 as a result of the expectations for a good rice output from the rice main cropping season. In February 2010, the price is at the same level of two years ago. Similarly, quotations of red beans have been constantly decreasing since mid-2008 when they were more than 50 percent higher compared to the level of February 2010. Despite the reduced 2009 production, the good availability of red beans from Honduras and Nicaragua, which should have enough surpluses for export, are maintaining the price low.

Quotations of white maize continued to remain stable in line with the





GIEWS Country Brief

El Salvador

Reference Date: 10-September-2009

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Low rainfall level could hamper maize production
- Good production prospects for beans in 2009
- Retail prices for beans show a positive downward trend

The drought may depress maize output

Despite the heavy rainfall which has been causing landslides and damage throughout the country in recent days, the total volume of rainfall in the past two months still remains far below normal levels throughout the North and in most of the interior valleys in the East and West, destroying almost 120 000 tonnes of crops nationwide.

In the eastern and western zones, which have been most seriously affected by the lack of water, the Ministry of Agriculture (MAG) has put losses at 10 and 25 percent, respectively, in these two zones.

Compared with the initial sowing forecasts of 306 000 hectares nationwide it is now predicted that this figure will fall by about 12 percent, taking account of the 39 000 hectares damaged to varying degrees.

Rice: no damage reported

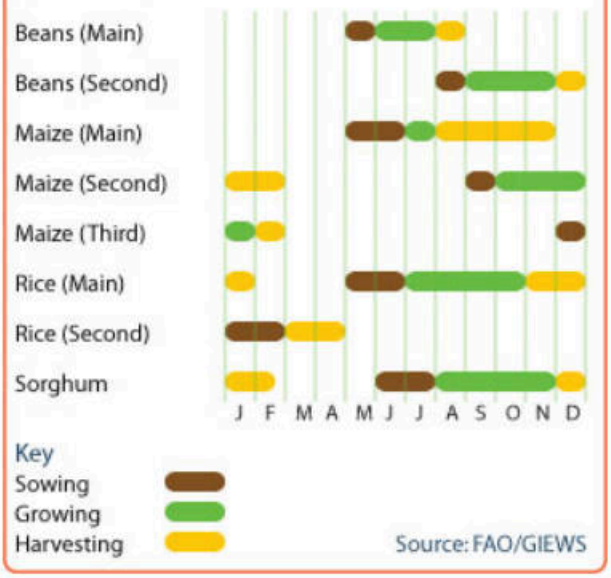
According to the MAG, the rice harvest is guaranteed because it is sown in the Irritation Districts, mainly in Atiocoyo Norte and Atiocoyo Sur both of which are in the north of the Department of La Libertad and the west of the Department of Chalatenango.

Fresh investment in bean farming

With an MAG investment of USD 8.7 million, more than 160 000 farmers have been supplied with bean seed.

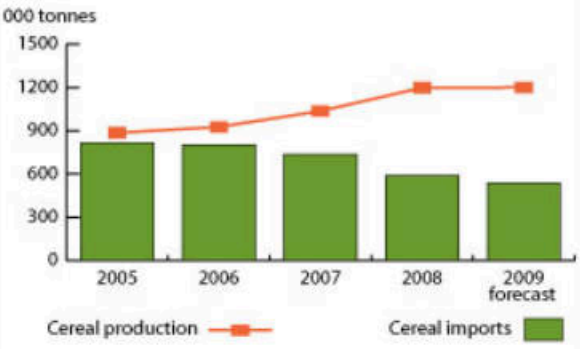
This will make it possible to expand the areas sown and raise bean production to 140 000 tonnes for the current agricultural cycle.

Crop calendar El Salvador



Cereal production and imports El Salvador

Cereal production	2004-2008 average	2008	2009 forecast	change 2009/2008
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	786	975	990	1.5%
Sorghum	167	201	184	-8.5%
Rice (milled)	20	23	27	17.4%
Total Cereals	972	1199	1201	0.2%



Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets